

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends — 2024 Stack Over

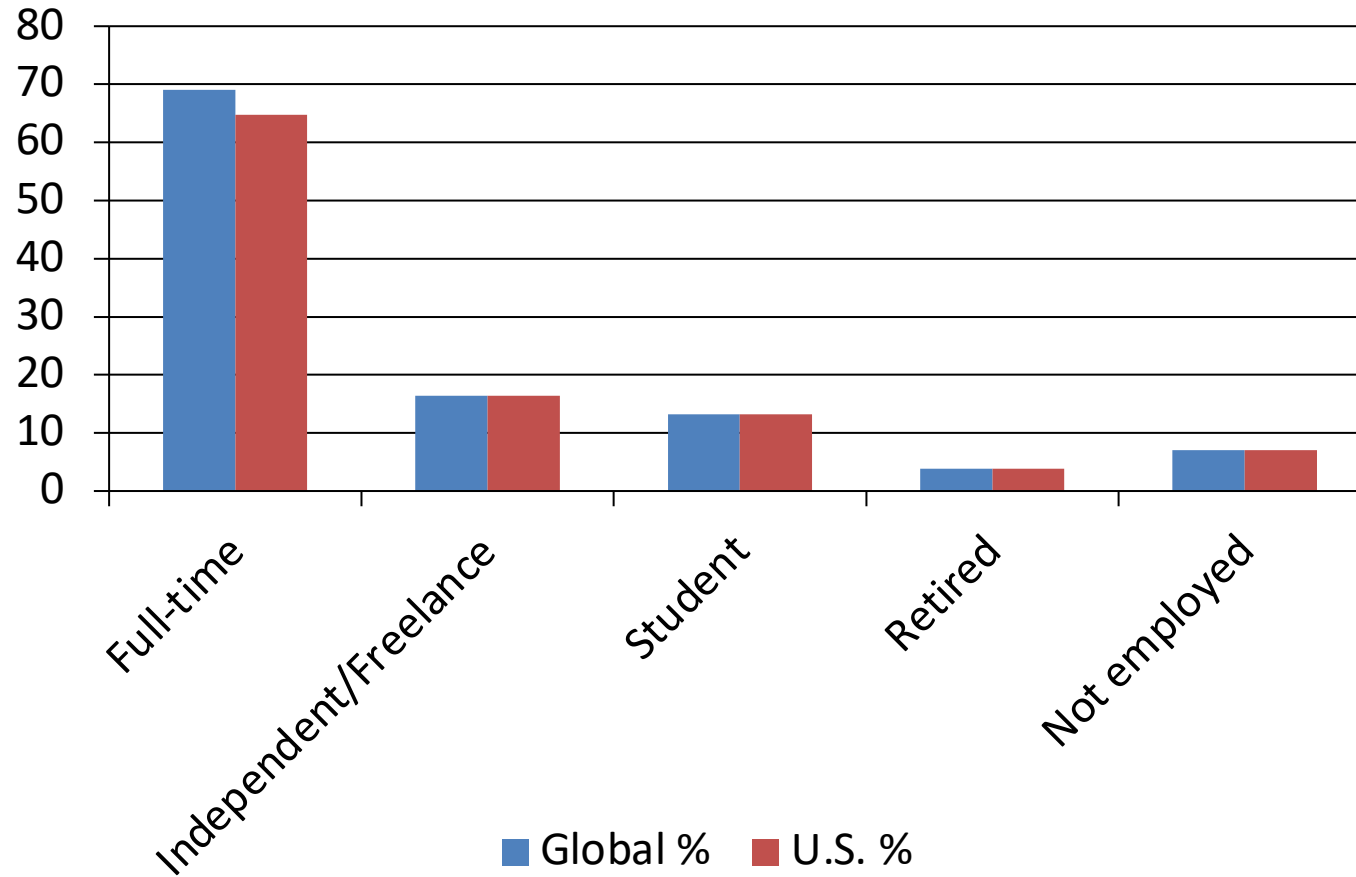
65,437 respondents across 180+ countries

Audience: Engineering managers and HR leaders

Focus: Workforce mix, salary benchmarks, and hiring/retention implications

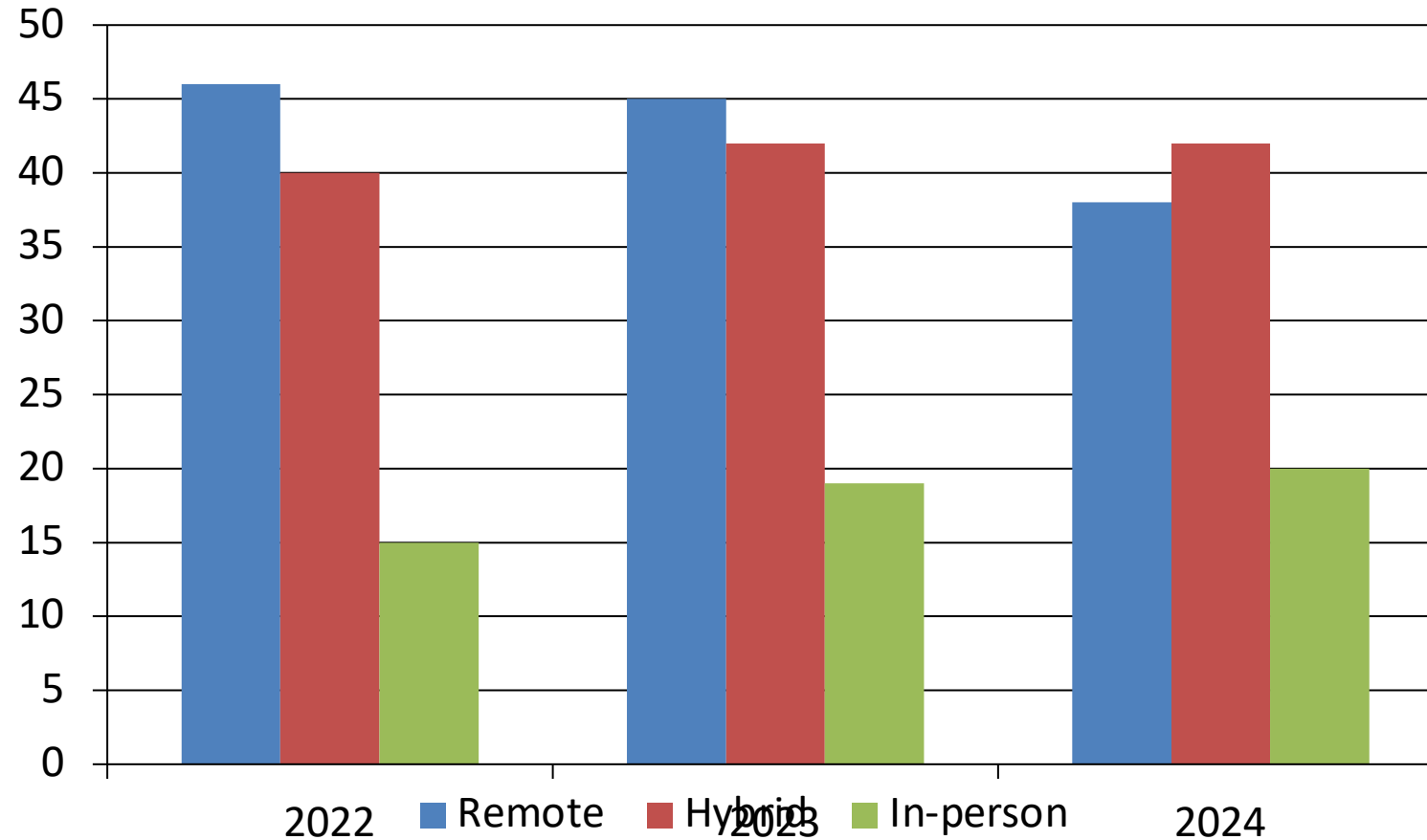
Scope: Employment status, work environment, role & language compensation, purchasing influence

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips



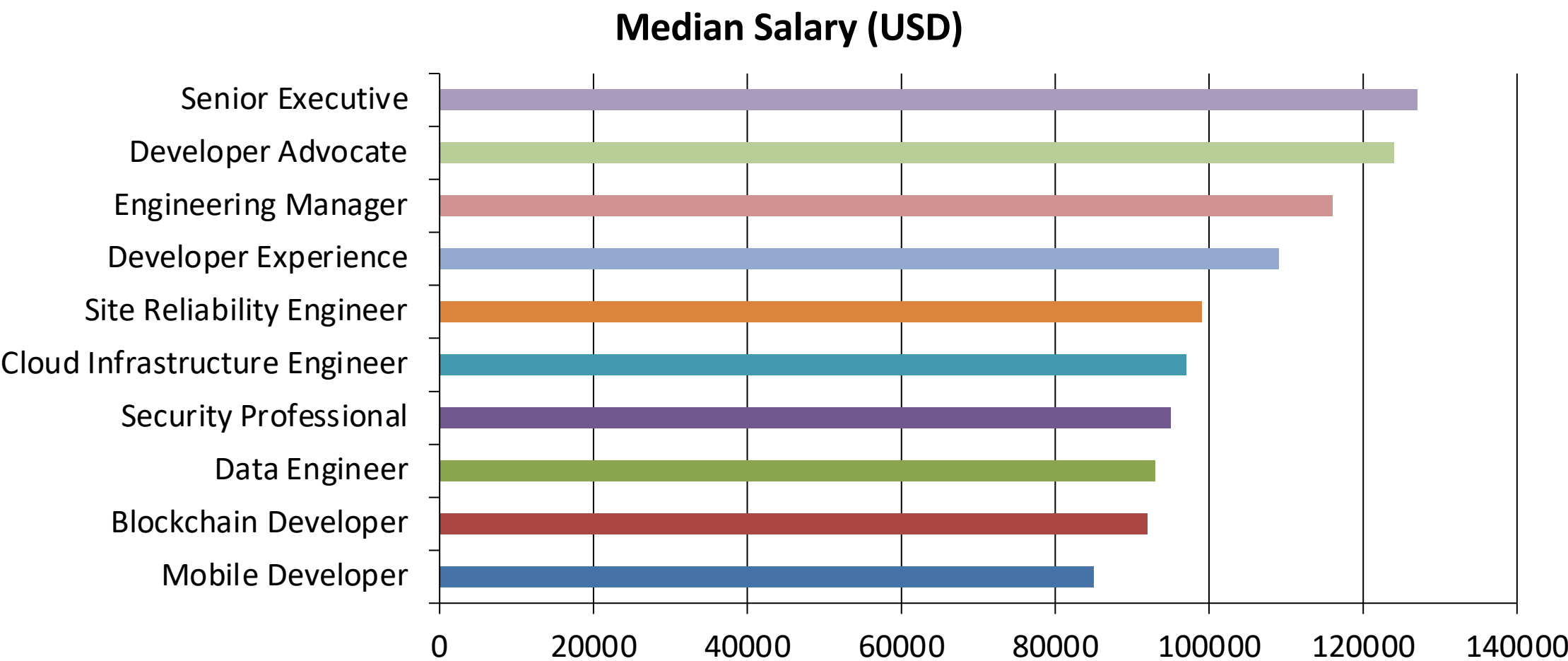
84% report being employed in some capacity.
Global full-time employment: 69%.
U.S. full-time dropped from 69% (2023) to 64.8% (2024)
Freelancing/contracting remains material at 16.4%.

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%



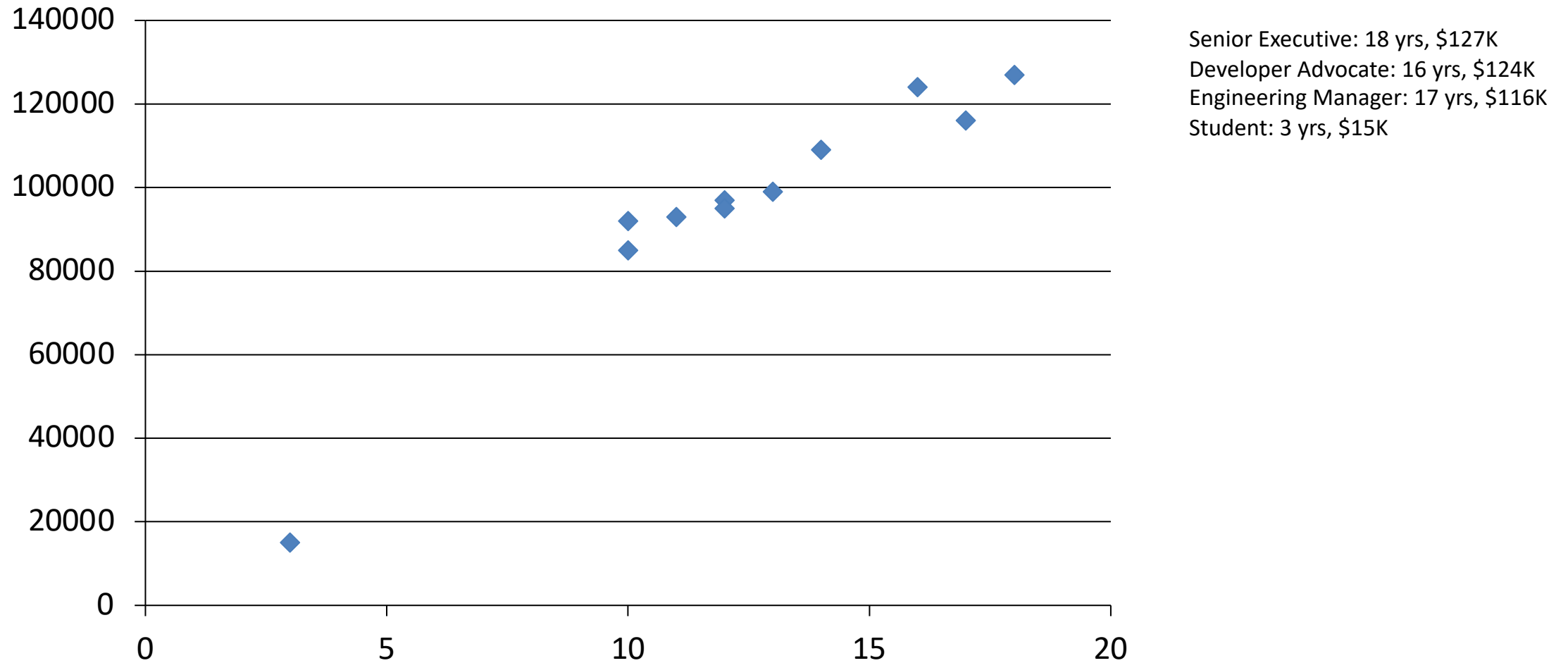
In-person rose +5 pts since 2022 (15% → 20%).
Hybrid remains steady at 42% in 2023–2024.
Remote declined to 38% in 2024 from 46% in 2022.

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary

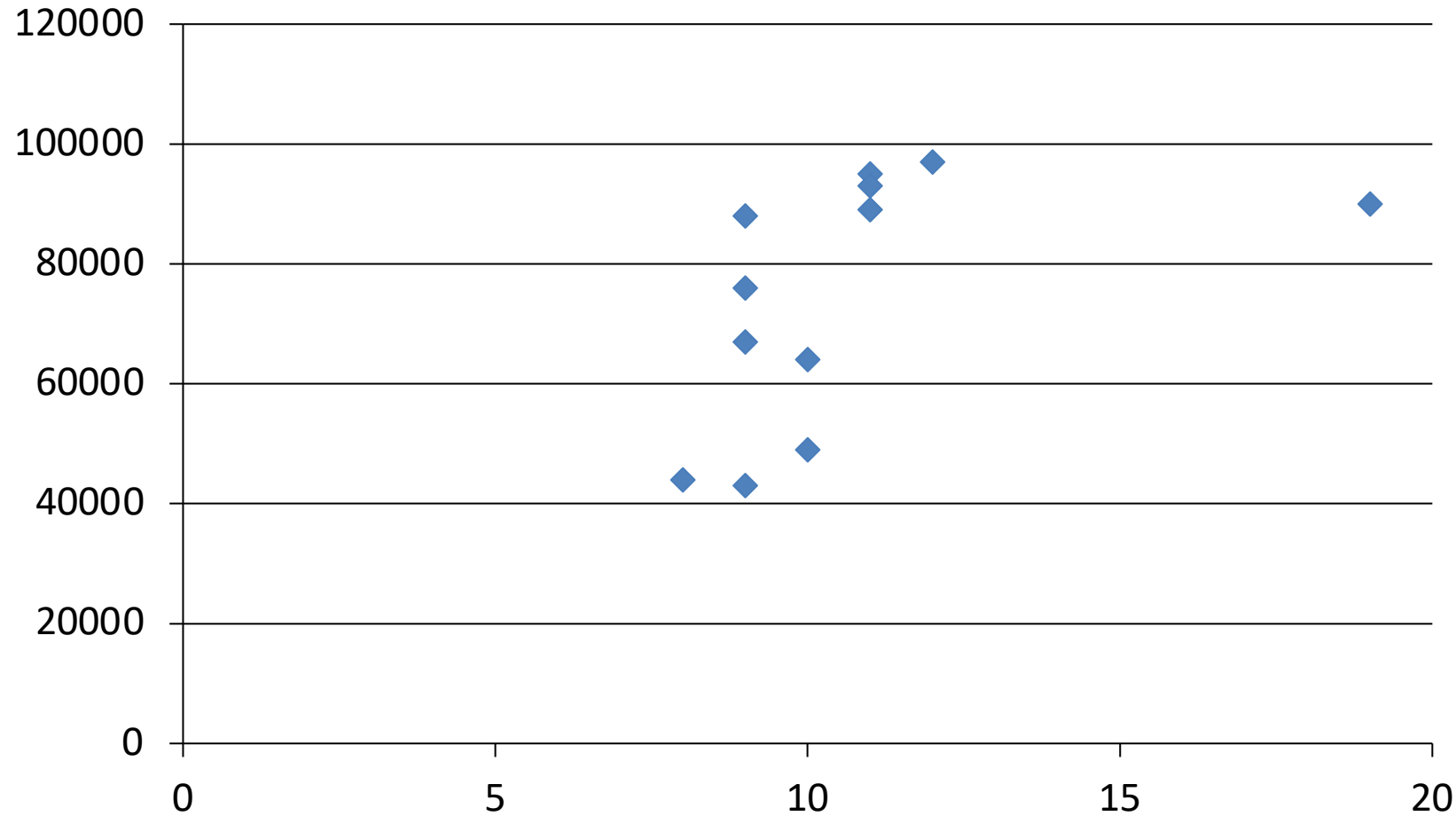


Source: Stack Overflow 2024 Developer Survey (as provided in source brief)

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries

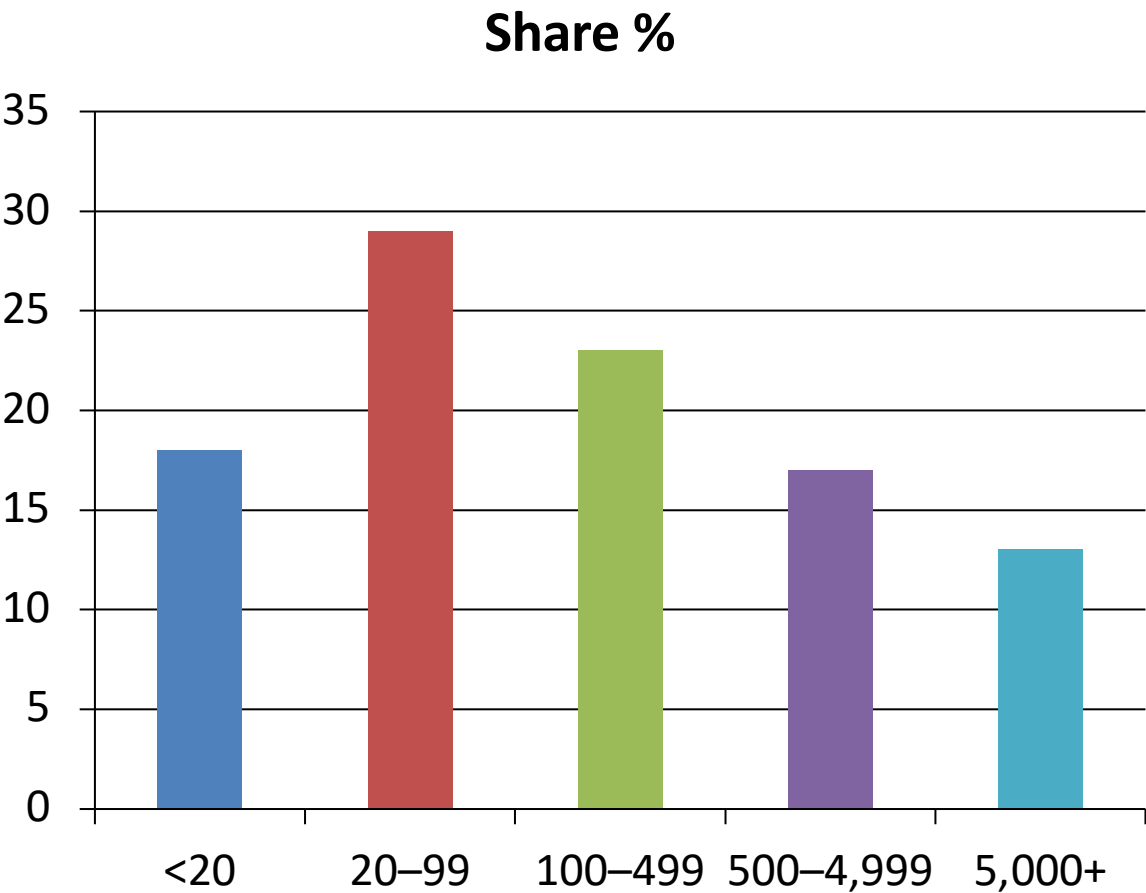


Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$40K



Top: Erlang \$97K, Clojure \$95K, Elixir \$93K
Lowest: Dart \$44K, Prolog \$43K, PHP \$49K
Overall reported range down ~ \$10K vs 2023

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases



47% work at organizations with fewer than 100 employees.
26% work at enterprises with 5,000+ employees.
62% influence technology purchases.
Highest influence cohorts: Senior executives (99%), Engineering managers (87%)
60% prefer build-and-buy; top evaluation methods: free trial (75%) and peer i

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

Plan workforce mix for softer full-time trends: retain flexibility across FTE, contract, and freelance channels.

Design location policies around hybrid reality: in-person is rising, but hybrid remains dominant at 42%.

Budget competitively for premium roles: DevRel, engineering leadership, and SRE-related tracks command top comp.

Use language-market signals in compensation bands: niche functional stacks correlate with higher median pay.

Enable developer-led tool adoption: with 62% influencing purchases, engage ICs directly in buying journeys.